

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] First of all, do you agree to participate in the study in accordance with the informed consent form I sent you today?

Speaker 2 [00:00:08] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:09] Okay, first of all, I will ask you a few demographic questions, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:15] [26-30].

Speaker 1 [00:00:16] [26-30]. How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:21] Almost [1-5] years.

Speaker 1 [00:00:23] Okay. Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:26] No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:28] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:00:30] Just my partner and me.

Speaker 1 [00:00:32] Okay. What is your main source of income? What is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:00:37] I am a [occupation].

Speaker 1 [00:00:39] Okay. How would you like us to address your partner? Partner, lover, spouse?

Speaker 2 [00:00:46] It doesn't make any difference, honestly. Partner.

Speaker 1 [00:00:49] Okay. Now I'm going to ask questions in a more romantic context. Can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2 [00:01:00] Of course. Well, actually we met [6-10] years ago, we met at the [location], he had a partner. I was in a community. We met in the context of the community. We were friends for many years, close friends. Then he broke up with his partner. I had a partner and we got a little bit closer and so on. But we started an open relationship. We are now in an open relationship at the same time. I don't know if this information is okay. Then we continued together. That's how it is.

Speaker 1 [00:01:37] How would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:01:44] I think it's a quality relationship because we have a kind of relationship where we never cross the respect line. We don't disrespect each other in any way. It's a pleasant relationship, it's a funny relationship and when I compare my previous relationships, not only my friends but also my previous relationships, I think it's a healthy relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:02:08] Can I ask you why you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:02:12] Of course. Well, first of all, I think we are mature people. I mean, we know what we want, we know what we want for ourselves, myself regardless of the relationship, we respect each other's space. So we don't enter each other's spaces at all. In our hobbies, in our entertainment life, in our friendships, in our work life. We never interfere in each other's lives. We just try to enjoy the time we spend together. That's why I think it's healthy.

Speaker 1 [00:02:42] So what do you think creates a pleasant time in your relationship? How do you have a pleasant time?

Speaker 2 [00:02:51] Hmm, I never thought about that. Well, actually, after all, we both know what we like for years and years. I know what I like, I know which movie type I like, which book type I like. He knows what he likes and when one of us shares with the other, if it fits, a common sharing is formed. If it doesn't fit, there is still a common sharing. It's like this, let's say, for example, he likes reading [book] a lot, I don't like it that much, but when he reads [book], I don't go near him at all. You know, he reads and enjoys his [book], or I have a more active social life. He doesn't interfere with my social life in any way, while I like that social life more. So we also enjoy the pleasures we get from each other separately. The other person enjoys it or enjoys hanging out alone. Or when we can find a common movie, book, sharing, conversation - and I think the most important thing is to talk - we can talk all the time without getting bored and we can talk about anything. This is beautiful. I mean, I think that's what makes it beautiful, being able to talk.

Speaker 1 [00:04:08] Well, for example, you talked about respecting each other when you spend time apart. How do you think this respect for each other, for the time spent apart reflects on your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:04:21] It goes like this, I mean, let me tell you from my point of view, I mean, his view was relatively like this. I think he will define it himself. I mean, sometimes people want to be alone. I mean, he wants to be alone even when there are people with him. You don't always want to chat or you don't always want to do something in common. You just want to be alone, and since this state of being alone is good for the person, it makes the time you spend together enjoyable. Because it's hard for me to live in a forced, close-knit, sticky way all the time. Same with him. Because let's say he wants to watch a movie, but I don't. So what should we do, are we going to watch movies by force or read books by force or socialize by force, this can start to become a bit toxic. You know, I went to my friends, so come on, let's go everywhere together, let's go to the family environment together. This did not seem very healthy to us. We love individuality very much, but what happens? Let's say when we meet on a common ground, let's

say when that social environment, book-movie environment is common, it is much, much more enjoyable than maybe it will be forced at that moment because it is suitable for both of us.

Speaker 1 [00:05:46] Hmm. So can I ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:05:53] Do the tiny, little, little things count or should I count the big things?

Speaker 1 [00:05:58] However you want to answer.

Speaker 2 [00:06:00] So I can say [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:06:05] Okay. It will be a bit repetitive. You've just answered it but how would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:06:15] Too high quality.

Speaker 1 [00:06:17] Can I ask you why you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:06:22] There is a relationship where respect is not lost. We also respect our private life. So we don't own each other, we often say that. I mean we don't own each other, just because we are in a relationship now we will never lose each other, we don't belong to each other. We just like spending time together. But in other relationships, when I compare in detail with previous relationships, there were more givers and takers. I mean, the side that spends more money, the side that thinks more or the side that makes you think more. You know, I was the one who was more giving in terms of character, so that the other person would be happy the most, that is, I don't try to make the other person happy, I am happy with the person next to me. There is such a difference, basically. Because I have had relationships in which I was financially and morally exploited, in which I was constantly emotionally, how should I put it, constantly feeding people's emotional hunger. But it is never like that in this relationship. I never even experienced it, and at first I was constantly trying to give in to the relationship with the habit of the past, but he didn't get it because he was trying to give and he was like that as a character. It was "You be the happiest". Of course, at some point we collided, we said no, this is wrong, let's not do this and we found our balance very quickly. Neither side gives, we just enjoy ourselves. That's why I find the relationship I'm in now healthier.

Speaker 1 [00:07:59] So somewhere in your answer you said that it is a relationship where respect is not lost. Can you give concrete examples of losing respect or not losing respect?

Speaker 2 [00:08:09] I can explain it like this. Let me go through examples again. For example, I think in a relationship you should not make comments or judgments about your partner's family or friends. In other words, you should not be judgmental in any decision about any form of relationship that he/she has experienced, has experienced in the past or is currently experiencing. I mean, this family is like this. I don't know, this friend is like this, your ex-partner

is like this, etc. I'm not talking about the subject enough to prevent the person from sharing, because we both know everything about each other's past, including the processes we have gone through, or we know the people who come into our lives. And when we start to enter that space, when we start to make negative comments about our past or the people we live with now, respect disappears after a while. Because the person doesn't start thinking for themselves. You start thinking for them or they start thinking for you. I think it has such a negative effect. Or not only that. For example, let me talk about my own social life. I love that social life. I can hang out all the time, I can be at events all the time. And there are so many people in my life. At some point, jealousy comes into play here. You know, jealousy is almost non-existent in our relationship. I mean, not at all. Because for me at least, jealousy arises at a point of inadequacy. I don't show it, the other person doesn't show it either, and it feeds our trust in each other. Therefore, we don't enter that area of respect, we don't disrespect each other. We don't damage that trust either. We just trust the other person and say, yes, if you are happy with your family like this, this is how it is, if you are happy with your friends like this, this is how it is, or with your partners because we don't have someone in both of our lives right now, but we have always kept it open that it can happen, if it can happen, this is how it is, that respect. Not only that, but I think when he says I just want to put my feet up and go to bed today, not to force him to go out is also a form of respect. General respect for his decisions is what I am talking about.

Speaker 1 [00:10:31] Okay. So what makes a relationship high quality for you? Or what makes it low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:10:39] It's the happiness of the person. Happiness varies from person to person. I mean, some may enjoy sociability like me. Some may enjoy being alone. Or some may enjoy just looking at the walls. If a person is happy in a relationship or in more than one relationship, I think what provides this happiness is that the person can do what they want. If I can do what I want and I don't enter someone else's private life, if I don't violate someone else's boundaries, I think this makes the relationship quality. I can define it as a happiness where no one else's boundaries are violated.

Speaker 1 [00:11:17] Okay. So how do you think a person can recognize that they're in a happy relationship where they're not violating someone else's boundaries?

Speaker 2 [00:11:28] So it's a feeling. Because it's like this. I mean, in unhappy relationships, not only in partnerships but also in friendships, when you're in an unhappy relationship, there's always a voice in the back of your head. What if something is wrong, what if something is bad? What if I'm doing something wrong? There is a constant need to apologize or a constant need to say thank you. You know, someone does a very simple little thing. Normally, it's like passing the salt, I'm throwing it in, and he feels the need to say thank you, I'll tell you from my own experience. But when he is happy, it is not like that. So you don't apologize all the time, you don't feel the need to explain things all the time. You don't have to text every decision. Or you don't have long correspondences. Or the simplest one. Let's say there was tension, a disagreement or our ideas could not meet on a common ground. At this point, instead of breaking the other person, we give each other time to calm down. Maybe we give 10 minutes,

maybe we give a month. It depends entirely on the subject. The other person, that is, me and my partner in the same way. We give each other time to analyze the situation. It's not a quick explanation, not a quick solution. It's more of a pause button and I think it's functional to stop any unhappy moment. And that creates a happier, more peaceful feeling.

Speaker 1 [00:13:07] So thinking in the context of your own relationship, when did you think your relationship was the happiest or the least happy?

Speaker 2 [00:13:19] From the very beginning, I mean that feeling never went away. Of course the first, I mean the first couple of months were a bit complicated. It was a period when we were both still in a relationship. It was a bit complicated for the first few months but it was always there, there was happiness and it's still there. It's never diminished, it's increasing. Of course many ideas changed. I mean, we were going against many stereotypes. You know, like marriage, like the word "spouse", we were very much against that, or we were a little bit behind, like how much we should fit into these norms that society gives us. But they also loosened as opinions. You know, anything can happen. This is our field, this is our space. Why not? Why should it only belong to someone and somewhere....

Speaker 1 [00:14:15] The sound is a bit crackly at the moment, by the way.

Speaker 2 [00:14:18] How is it now?

Speaker 1 [00:14:20] Better now, yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:14:24] I was saying, I mean it's so nice to wake up with that person, it's so nice to know that he loves you, it's so nice to feel that you love him. In that respect, that happiness has never gone away. It just keeps changing its shape. It's not in one place. There is nothing I can say I love (sevmek) for that. Because I think love (sevgi) is a whole. It is very difficult to reduce it to one thing.

Speaker 1 [00:14:46] Well, for example, you said that your happiness has been increasing, compared to the beginning of the relationship. For example, which processes do you think increased this happiness?

Speaker 2 [00:14:57] Seeing the selflessness of the other person and the fact that he sees my selflessness caused a mutual increase. Because we actually started to get closer during the pandemic. Literally, this is how our relationship has settled. And in this pandemic, we were locked in a house, we couldn't get out, he couldn't leave. He had evening freedom, but he couldn't go, her house was too far away. We were locked in our house, my roommate and the three of us. And at that time, of course, many tensions overlap. It was a period when people's nerves were worn out, both financially and spiritually. But we got through that period very comfortably. Only once we were very tense because he couldn't leave the house and I was always outside. He was very overwhelmed because he was always indoors. But even in that tension, we never broke each other, we never raised our voices or attacked each other as if we

were trying to get revenge on each other. I don't know how to describe it anymore, a state of toxicity. Because that never happened, for example, that was one of the turning points for me. Because I knew that the other person was trying not to hurt me and I was trying not to hurt him. That was a very important moment for me. Other than that, it's not a big "that moment" but little by little. I know that he is in my mind or I know that I'm in his mind. You know, knowing this actually increased over time. Or little gifts, little surprises, I don't know, any thoughtful gesture. Anything. I mean, waking up in the morning and fulfilling each other's needs, a little touch during the day, many things actually nourish it. Again, it's not just one thing.

Speaker 1 [00:16:50] Well, for example, you said that you experienced a tension during the pandemic period. How did you solve this tension, how were you able to solve it?

Speaker 2 [00:16:57] By talking. I mean, from our minds, I remember more clearly from my point of view, of course, I clearly said what it made me feel. I mean, I said it clearly without any censorship. I feel this and I said what I want to feel and what I don't want to feel in that process. Likewise, he did the same. He said I feel this but I don't want to feel this, I want to feel this and it was resolved very quickly. You know, it was solved on the same day. Maybe that was even our biggest argument. I don't even remember a discussion beyond that.

Speaker 1 [00:17:35] Okay. You actually touched on some of these things in your previous answers, but since this is the main topic of our project, I want to ask you again. What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:17:48] Respect. Being able to talk, I mean being able to communicate and not violating private space. So it goes to respect in general. Anything beyond that already leads to that. Together, especially if we have something in common. So yes, we have common ground. I don't know if we would be like this if we didn't have common ground, but we have a lot of common interests. But I would say because of the respect we have for our different interests.

Speaker 1 [00:18:19] Hmm. You talked about common ground. Can we give concrete examples here?

Speaker 2 [00:18:24] Sure. We like almost the same movie type. We like almost the same books. We like to do research very much. So we can research any topic, any agenda, we can go over and over. So that it's something completely unrelated. For example, he loves to learn languages. All of a sudden he started studying [Language], and all of a sudden I started doing [occupation], and we said let's research both. We stopped and said let's learn sign language, and we started researching together. Or we are very good with nature. We are very good with street animals. The common grounds of both of us were actually the stray animals that introduced us. And you know, when there is something about them, we can solve it together. I mean, he also feeds them because, for example, we are both vegan, my partner was vegan before me and I became vegan afterwards. That became a new common ground for us. Then it became an area where we could share more, which I was very close to these issues at the time. Things like that. I couldn't think of too many examples.

Speaker 1 [00:19:38] So what is love for you?

Speaker 2 [00:19:42] For me, love is something that is felt instantly. So love can be a temporary thing. Because I have had relationships where I say I was in love, where I felt love. And I think it's a bit more objective. I feel like love (aşk) is more like a love (sevgi) for what. You know, there is someone very beautiful, someone with a very high aura. You like them, it's more like love. I can say that I am a person who believes in love (sevgi) rather than love (aşk).

Speaker 1 [00:20:12] So what do you think are the points that differentiate love (aşk) and love (sevgi)?

Speaker 2 [00:20:19] I mean, I don't know how accurate it is to separate them. Because there are places where the two are one. You know, I think it's good when it's not just love (aşk) all the time, but love (sevgi), respect, love (aşk) all together. But if there is a differentiating point, I think love (sevgi) is more long-term, because, I mean, it's not just for the partner. For example, I am someone who is on good terms with his family right now. Even in our family, we can love (sevmek) and hate at the same time, we can be angry and resentful at the same time, but I don't believe that love (aşk) is continuous. It has such a different point. But love (sevgi), I think love (sevgi) is something that can be a constant thing. You know, whether you are angry, sad, or unhappy, I don't think that love (sevgi) is damaged there.

Speaker 1 [00:21:13] So what is love (sevgi) for you?

Speaker 2 [00:21:18] A great happiness. I mean love, I never had to define it, let me define it through my relationship. I don't know how to define love in general right now. I think love includes all the good feelings I feel for the other person, it includes everything for me. It includes seeing him in the morning. Coming to him in the evening, he works at home. The need to go to him and hug him is also included in my love. It includes kissing him, it includes just chatting, it includes being in his mind when we are far away, it includes a small little chat. Many things fall under the scope of love for me. For example, we do a lot of flowers, buying flowers for each other. I'm talking about green leafy plants, giving each other green leafy plants as a gift is also love, or hanging the laundry that day is also love. You know, everything that we do in the house, everything that we experience while living together is actually a show of love towards each other.

Speaker 1 [00:22:27] So how important do you think love is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:33] I mean, it would be nice if it happens, I have it, it would be nice if it happens. But I don't know, I've never thought about it. I don't know the answer to this question for myself.

Speaker 1 [00:22:44] Okay. So you just talked about it a little bit but how do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:22:53] Well, first of all he tells and he shows. He shows it like this. He never puts me in front of himself. Because I never put him in front of me, but I know that he's always somewhere in my mind. So it's not just like an interest, like he did this to me when I was sick, he took care of me, or I don't know, I was going to work, he prepared dinner. Or he was on his way to work, so I prepared dinner. But there are a lot of things he does all the time like, well, you know, my partner would be happy to see this. Here, Başak would be happy if I buy this. Yes, I would be. I mean, why wouldn't I be happy if I hug him. All kinds of behaviors, for example, when he makes me laugh, it makes me happy, I laugh.

Speaker 1 [00:23:53] So what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:58] The difficulties in our relationship are not so much within ourselves, but there is of course the difficulty of being an outward identity. Because we live in [Country] right now and [Country] is not a place that can accept people with our identity very easily. We are in a society with a very serious tendency towards violence against us and we both have open identities. There are a lot of people that we are examples for and stand side by side with. We meet a lot of people younger than us. You know, they think of us as older brothers and sisters. Sometimes they ask questions. We try to create a safe space in this area. We also have an activist side and this is not easy. In other words, unfortunately, the identity that our relationship takes rather than our relationship challenges us. Our only advantage is that our families know about it, which makes us a little bit more comfortable. Or the fact that there are people around us who respect queer identity, how accurate it is to say identity, but respect our identity, makes us a little more comfortable. But in general, there is a security problem and this security problem is increasing day by day. I have been living in the center of [Location] for a very long time, and while I used to be able to walk around here, now I wonder. I mean, while there were queer flags hanging everywhere before, now I wonder. While everyone could come to my house before, there is an ever-increasing security problem like I don't want to let everyone in my house anymore. Actually, other than that, we don't have a big problem. The people around us don't understand the open relationship that much. But they don't understand, so this is not a problem for us. But within ourselves, I can say there is no problem. Because it's like this. Of course, we are human, there are always small problems or differences of opinion. But we try to do this and we say that we have the solution to every problem. As long as we can talk, we don't think there is a problem that cannot be solved. We can talk about everything that doesn't make sense to us and because we talk about it, even if a problem is very important to us at that moment, it remains too much to remember, it remains distant. That's why I can't remember the problems we have now. I don't remember our discussions and disagreements in detail very much.

Speaker 1 [00:26:36] Uh-huh. If you don't mind, I would like to talk a little bit more about the reflections of living this queer relationship in [Country A]. Because this study is a cross-cultural study. It is also being done in countries like [Country B] and [Country C]. And I believe that we can offer a little more perspective there. How do you think living a queer relationship in [Country A] reflects on your relationship, how does it reflect on your relationship quality?

Speaker 2 [00:27:05] Now, I cannot say that there is only a bad side. There is also a good side to it. Let me talk about the bad side first, and then I would like to talk a little bit about the positives that it actually adds to us. The bad side is of course first and foremost the security problem. You see this constant urge to wonder who is homophobic, who can harm me, even when you go to the grocery store, it comes from the people you least expect, it comes from your close friends. Because there are not many people in [Country A] who know about this field. So even if people know, not everyone is open. Yes, there are associations, there are people working and putting effort in this field. Or there is collective work in universities. They are trying, they are trying to do it. But for example, [University] was closed down. A community that was opened in our time, when I was studying at university there, was closed this year and it was closed for purely political reasons. You know, while there was an upswing there, especially since [Year], we see that this is reeling back, and [10-15] years is a very short period of time, in fact, for an organization, it started to rot in [10-15] years. It is troubling in this respect. These anti-queer marches that started in [Country] last year and the marches that turned violent are frightening. Because it can spread anywhere at any moment. I live in [Location] and there are a lot of sex workers in [Location] and they have been on the streets for as long as I can remember. There was a period when people were hunting, beating and killing them like they were on a hunt. As far as I know, there have been no murders for a while. But for a while there was a murder here, this person died, this person was killed, this person was beaten. You know, if you can't even walk on your street, in your neighborhood, there is a problem there. So there is an open hatred because there is hatred against people here, against people with this identity. Especially people who don't fit into the mold of society, for example, I am a relatively feminine person, but if you don't fit that mold, they can easily label you. They can target you very easily. They find it within their rights to make remarks while walking on the road, or you can be subjected to cyber bullying on social media very quickly. For example, here you go to the [Month Day] [Month], even on [Month] [Day], I mean, there are people of all identities there. On [Month] [Day], the women's movement, for example, for a very long time they resorted to a way of not accepting queer individuals. But the night marches prevented this. They said, "No, we are here too, I mean I am here too, I feel myself in this identity and I am here too, I will march". So the difficulties are not only with people who have no knowledge of this field or who hate it, these difficulties also exist within themselves. I don't think it is a one-way difficulty. There are difficulties for people with bisexual identities. For example, we are in an open relationship and there are difficulties against us. People can also start to be the judging party even though they themselves have been judged. So I think this does not end when you are in this identity. These are the problems in general. Of course, there is always the danger of being killed, you are in danger of being beaten up, or work life is troublesome. In business life, for one thing, you cannot have an open identity, you cannot enter the public, if you do, you will not be accepted. Even if you start officially somehow, they will not accommodate you there. They give you nicknames very quickly, let me say that they can slip on your feet in different ways. For example, I never thought about working in the public sector in my life. I never wanted to work in the public sector, just because I knew I couldn't live this identity comfortably. It has such difficulties. In fact, when you ask almost any queer individual in [Country], there are difficulties they can tell you. But the biggest problem is the ever-increasing security. Constantly increasing "I wonder how?". I, for example, am a person who loves my country very much. I love living in

my country, I am in love with [Country]. But why am I constantly experiencing the urge to go abroad just because of this identity? I mean, it's not economics, family, or anything else, it's just being in a queer identity, I wonder if I should go abroad, I wonder when that moment will come, for example, we are trying to learn the language because if we go one day, let's not flounder. Why am I constantly experiencing this fear so that if one day we defect from here, we won't falter? Or why do people with my identity constantly experience this fear? This is the biggest problem. The advantage is that we are not involved in the marriage-divorce processes in a hetero relationship that society sees as normal or that the majority sees as normal. One second.

Speaker 1 [00:32:31] I think there is a connection problem right now.

Speaker 2 [00:32:48] Is my voice coming through now?

Speaker 1 [00:32:52] Right now, yes.

Speaker 2 [00:32:53] Heh okay, the machine was running, so that there wouldn't be too much noise. Now here are the advantages. People in this country have a tariff that they apply to a hetero couple. If you are partners, your families meet, you meet. Everyone gets to know each other, mingle. Cousins get involved, friends, relatives get involved. There is pressure on these people, when is the engagement, when is the wedding. They can't do that to us. At least our families cannot do that because they know that. I mean, foreigners outside can get into this. Yes, relatives may be able to attack people with our identity, but for example, no one in my family can do it directly to me anymore. Because they all know and they know that I will make fun of them when they say it. I say it's not legal, if it was legal I would get married and the subject is closed there, they can't take it further. But for example, I have a brother and they can constantly pressure him to get married. For example, we have such an advantage. They have the advantage of not being able to enter that field. Of course this is like this. This is not one-sided. There is a view that no one can be free until everyone is free. This actually liberates hetero couples as well. The free space they live in also liberates us. In other words, it also feeds the idea that we don't need to interfere in people's lives anymore, we can live in separate houses, we don't need to live in the same house. You know, it's not one-sided, it has such a comfort. I think your relationship is going better because not everyone can comment. Because it doesn't matter whether it's friends or family. When more than one person is involved, that relationship ceases to be a relationship, it becomes an issue, an agenda. I think being in a queer identity protects us a little bit from this, they cannot enter that space. Since they cannot enter, they cannot comment. Since they can't comment, it becomes a form of relationship where two people can talk. A third party cannot intervene in this relationship in any way. At least for our relationship, maybe not for everyone's relationship. Apart from that, another advantage, what I mean by advantage, that makes me happy is this: Even though this issue has its bad sides in [Country A], there is also a positive side to it, especially security. More people have started to have open identities. The number is increasing day by day. Knowledge in this field is also increasing day by day. Knowledge about sexual health is increasing, knowledge about the relationships people live in, emotional relationships is increasing, people don't stop and say when you say you are bisexual, what is that and what is not. Not everyone is trying to put

themselves into an identity. In other words, while before there were only lesbian and gay definitions, now there are many definitions and this is increasing day by day, and we are learning new ones every day. Each individual defines themselves in a different way. I don't define myself in any way, I don't fit into any mold. But we also need to learn those definitions because there are people who define themselves in those identities and it is of course a good thing that there are more spaces where this can be discussed in order to understand this in [Country A]. Of course, this happens in ghettos, in safer areas. People don't talk about these issues in areas where they don't feel safe. No matter where it is. I'm not talking about universities, I'm talking more about one-on-one conversations outside. It's not a subject that can be opened up in business life, it's very taboo, but despite that, a group of people, phenomena, of course, have an impact, queer phenomena. Thanks to their influence, people can say yes, this is also human. There are families who support queer children. I mean, there are families who say my child is queer, you will respect him, I am happy with my child. It is a great advantage for them to speak out. Because he is also my child and I don't want any harm to come to my child, parents whose child has an open identity, whose family can say this openly, of course, have a great advantage in this increase. But since evil always spreads faster than good, the security problem is unfortunately high.

Speaker 1 [00:37:21] Well, for example, you mentioned the increase in the areas that can talk in [Country], the increase in people with open identities. Does this increase in awareness reflect positively on your relationship? For example, do you think that these positive developments increase the quality of your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:37:40] Yes, I do. Because with this increase, at least in [City], there are queer-friendly places and I know that when I go to that establishment and sit down, I will feel safe there. The next table will not look at me, the owner will not exclude me there and I will spend more quality time. Wherever I go, it has such an advantage. Or when I go there, when I see a queer flag, I can say, "Yes, look, we are there too." And there is no such thing. Because I don't have to stop and hide my relationship, because I don't have to pretend to be friends, I spend time with my partner as I want. And because I spend time as I want, the quality is better. Because otherwise, for example, when we go to a more insecure area, when we go to an area where we don't feel comfortable, there is always a tension on us. Because we have to be constantly on edge in case they recognize our identity, or if they stick something to us, or if someone says something to us, and I can give an example of this. Again, when we are walking on the road, we are walking down the [Location]. A taxi driver is looking at us, staring at us like a psychopath. And I didn't notice it at first, my partner noticed it and turned around and said, "What are you looking at?". Now, there was no need, no reason, no right, and we spent an hour getting nervous for the other person. We are standing there for nothing and we are two people walking on the road, so what could you be looking at? You know, of course, having less of these things generally reduces the anger and stress in our lives. It has more of an effect like that.

Speaker 1 [00:39:30] So do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:39:35] No.

Speaker 1 [00:39:40] But do you have arguments?

Speaker 2 [00:39:43] We have differences of opinion. We are not very argumentative people in terms of character. I mean, I had an anger management problem long ago when I was in high school. But I solved it independently of my partner. He had it by his own declaration. He also solved it independently of me. And we are very much in favor of not solving any issue by fighting, not only in our relationship. So we don't fight in our relationship either.

Speaker 1 [00:40:12] So on which issues do these disagreements usually happen?

Speaker 2 [00:40:16] It happens on very simple things. You know, like what color this should be. It happens in very small things like that, or it happens like this, for example, sometimes one of us is stuck on a general idea about something, let's say about the world agenda, about the country's agenda, about our friendships, and the other one usually throws a different opinion. So those discussions are more like a debate rather than a discussion. We are trying to add a different point of view to each other, but it's not like that, it's not like refuting each other, it's more like discussions where we add something to each other, like look, there's this too, let's discuss this, let's improve this too. I mean, that is the maximum way of discussion. Those are the moments when we talk most seriously. And that usually evolves into something that improves us. So far, we have never had a conversation where we have refuted each other.

Speaker 1 [00:41:13] Well, for example, you said that these discussions improve us. Do you think these discussions also reflect on your relationship quality?

Speaker 2 [00:41:19] It reflects a lot. Because for example, let's say he defends issue A, I defend issue B, whatever the agenda is at that moment. After a while, both of us are defending topic C. In other words, we come out of our own view and we get a new view or we definitely add something to each other. And because we like to research and develop, especially in social fields because he studied sociology as a minor. I am very interested in human behavior. You know, I like to analyze people, I like to get to know human behavior. That's why it's developmental, that this could be like that. Because understanding these things also has the following effect: We are human, we can do anything. The important thing is how we overcome those processes and by listening to each other or by putting forward different opinions or different theories, by saying what would happen if it were like this, what would we do, we actually see each other's behaviors. We don't necessarily have to experience those events. It has such a quality. I don't know. I think it also increases the trust in the behavior of the other person.

Speaker 1 [00:42:35] Then can we say that creating a culture of being able to discuss with each other, being able to discuss different views with each other increases the quality of the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:42:45] Yes, for us it does.

Speaker 1 [00:42:48] So besides resolving these debates and discussing differences of opinion openly together, what are the other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:43:01] I think, I mean first of all it's communication. I'm not just talking about talking, I'm not talking about communication, you have to be in open communication. Beyond talking and arguing, even if it is not at the moment when something bothers you, it should be said at the first moment when it can be said. I am uncomfortable with this, or can we stop this, or can we not talk about it right now, can we not go over it right now, any behavior needs to be said openly. We should not take responsibility for each other except for talking. Because we are adults now and I am not my partner's parent and I shouldn't take care of him/her, nor should he/she be my parent and take care of me. Both financially and emotionally. There is no difference between the two at this stage. You know, I should take all his economic burden in my life and he should take mine. I'm not talking about that, I mean, one of us was in a bad financial situation at that time and we supported each other, that's another thing. But in a relationship where one is always giving or the other is always taking, there are breaks at the point where the giving party cannot give, especially in material things. This time the other person expects more from you, or when you devote all your time to your partner, you can't be alone when you want to be alone. This is also an important factor. I think that the person should create their own interests in a quality relationship. If not, they should create them. It's like this, because at some point your partner may not be in your life. For some reason. I mean, you may break up, your relationship may end. Another person may enter your life, the other person may die. I mean, if nothing happens, the other person may die. Or you might die. I think that when you live dependent on someone, their absence causes a much bigger destruction. But when you have your own space, you can be alone for once. You can develop more different ideas. Because when you act together all the time, you start to become one person, one body. There is no individuality this time. I think this is one of the most important things rather than talking. I think individuality should also be preserved.

Speaker 1 [00:45:24] So would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:45:28] It's perfect for me.

Speaker 1 [00:45:30] May I ask why you think so?

Speaker 2 [00:45:34] I'm happy, I'm happy, I'm happy uninterruptedly. It's a relationship that lasted for a very long time and you know people always think that a relationship has a duration, it's like, you know, a honeymoon, it's not like that. So this has also been taught wrongly, misrepresented by people. We have a past generation that tries to reflect those patterns they were forced to enter into to the next generation as if they were rules. There is a culture that reflects that every relationship has a fight, every relationship has unhappiness, every relationship has a bad period, but that is not the case. We now clearly see that this is not the case. We have another hetero couple friend and they are also very happy. Because they managed to get out of those molds. Not every relationship has fights. There doesn't have to be

a fight in every relationship if the parties don't want it. But we don't want that. There doesn't have to be fights, arguments, disagreements, being in a constant state of tension, or a relationship where one party is superior to the other, we learned that, and it makes us feel happy. Because I don't feel the need to explain to someone in the morning, in the evening, when I'm going to bed, or when I'm watching a movie. This is the point where I say yes, this is the right relationship. I don't have to explain things to someone all the time. I don't explain to my parents, I don't explain what I'm going to do, I don't explain to my partner, I don't have to think about what he's doing all the time. I mean what he is doing. For example, we are far away now. This is one of the advantages of our relationship, at least for us. We are not together all the time. She is in her hometown for [1-5] month, here for [1-5] months, or vice versa, we are in constant circulation, we are not side by side all the time. Therefore, we actually have more individual space than usual. This is good in this way, to create space when we are constantly side by side, I mean we create space, yes, but for example, he misses his family. I miss my family or I just want to spend time with my family without thinking about anything. Being away from time to time like this gives us an advantage and being able to do this, yes, I say I am in the right relationship. Because I stayed away from my partner for [1-5] month, I miss him a lot, both physically and emotionally. Yes, I miss it, but at the same time it feels good and we don't turn this state of missing into a toxic state of come to me or let me come to you. Yes, I think I am in the right relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:48:25] So has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:48:29] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:48:30] In what way has it changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:48:32] My change actually started before the relationship. I mean, this relationship came into my life at a time when I decided to remove everything in my life that made me unhappy, and we fed each other. That's how it changed. As I started to taste happiness, or rather, as I discovered how beautiful it is not to intrude into my space, how beautiful it is to focus only on my own pleasures, I was able to see and remove other toxic things in my life much more easily. So there is happiness there. There is a person who is not in your space in any way. There is a person you can talk to comfortably, you can share many things that you can solve by talking, and on the other hand, I had toxic friendships at that time. And I was able to distinguish those toxicities from each other. I mean, you look at one side and it's very bad, it's troubling, and you look at the other side and it can be possible. And in this cleaning, I mean, the people in my life and unhappiness, behavior, it doesn't mean that I only took people out. For example, there were some good things about my friendships, there were some friends I removed from my life, but I was also able to solve the toxins in my friendships in this process. You know, I learned that I should talk to those people. Instead of sitting unhappy, sulking, I showed them that I could talk and that those people should respect that. Because I respected it and there was too much interference in that area and those relationships became healthier. The rest of my friendships have also become one that doesn't hurt each other. My relations with my family became very smooth. Because when I came out as an identity, I went

through a very depressing process at that time, and my family accepted it, but it was like, let's not see it, they accepted it. They didn't have to accept my identity, but for some reason I had a perception in my head that I couldn't live this identity without their acceptance. And in the process, both the fact that they recognized my partner and the fact that they saw that I was actually happy helped my family to get through this process more easily for my family. Because of my mood, my daily life has evolved to a place where they no longer attack me, where they say yes, [Location] is happy. Because I work with my mother at the same time and we are always side by side, we are not far away. We are always together, and from a person who constantly intervened in this area, it has evolved to a parent who understands and accepts this identity, who sees that I am happy, who sees that this is a normal thing, who sees that this is not a disease. It evolved into a parent who can ask questions. Likewise, my brother is [1-5] years younger than me. At first accepting this was very difficult for him. He was even attacking me very seriously, verbally, not physically. He was verbally attacking me. But at some point he said, no, I am homophobic and I will solve this somewhere, I will solve it and come back to you, and he solved it within a year. I don't know what happened in his head anymore and we were able to get into an environment where my partner and I and his partner could sit and chat and drink raki. There were actually positive aspects of this relationship. Because what we call family tries to protect us on the one hand, and when they saw that I was happy, they stopped protecting and just accepted it. I think they realized that they had to respect that space. It had such a positive effect.

Speaker 1 [00:52:19] And did your partner change during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:52:24] I think he changed. We have an analogy, maybe I can explain if I say that. So we are trains on parallel tracks going parallel to each other, so we go side by side. Yes, sometimes we separate, sometimes we merge, but we don't enter each other's space. But at the same time, we are constantly feeding each other in every sense. I mean, in those first few months when we had a difficult time being independent of each other, when his private life and my private life were not yet on track, when we didn't contact each other much, when we didn't talk as much as we do now, of course, we started to carry the toxicities in our old relationships, both friendship and partnership, and we stopped them. I mean, he had a habit of sulking. I was always in such an unhappy state. I could be unhappy about anything all the time because I thought I had to explain something to the other person all the time. He would sulk very quickly, he would close himself off to communication. And we overcame these things over time and I think we changed a lot. I mean, I know that his views have also changed, and it would be healthier if he explains it himself. But let me give one example. For example, I proposed marriage to her and what she told me was that I wouldn't even dream of it. I mean, she said yes to me when we were so against marriage in the first place and then she came and proposed to me. You know, this is a big change for us. Because it was like a miracle for us that two people who were so against the pattern of marriage proposed to each other a few days apart. Now we are planning a wedding, we will do it secretly, but that's okay.

Speaker 1 [00:54:14] I wish you much happiness in advance. And do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:54:22] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:54:24] Can you explain a little bit more why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:54:27] Of course. From the very beginning of my relationship, that's the one thing that I think about and I'm sure about, trust. Maybe, for example, you asked about happiness, trust might be one of the reasons. Because I saw that my partner never violated the safe space of his ex-partners when he was talking about them. I mean, even though the relationship was over and he actually had big problems, he never talked bad about them. She always had a way of talking only about her own feelings and how she felt, and that gave me a lot of confidence. Because even if we have a problem one day, I know that the other person will not act with the motive of harming me. So I feel very safe in this relationship from the very beginning. I hope I was able to give him this trust too. Because in a broken relationship, in relationships, more precisely, people can be destructive. They may want to upset the other person or they may want to share their problems with everyone. But I have such a beautiful partner that I don't want to stay angry. There is a person who says I just want to remember that person beautifully and he always remembers that way. Of course, there are small problems from time to time, but instead of evolving into something like gossip, it's like this. You know when you listen to someone's story and you learn from it, there are stories told like that, more like the way they talk about it. This also happened and I learned a lesson from it, like in my life. There is a way of him describing a relationship that doesn't turn into anger, doesn't turn into unhappiness or doesn't go into a space where you can make bad comments on his ex-partners. This is very reassuring. Very much. Even if we end it one day, and I hope we don't, I know that nothing will happen to me. I will not be harassed in any way by that person, maybe by phone, maybe in writing, maybe in person. I know that he will not do it in any way, because I have seen it happen to none of his other relationships.

Speaker 1 [00:56:44] Okay. Now I'm going to share a screen with you. If I ask you if my partner really listens to me. On a scale of 1: not true at all, to 9: completely true, what would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:57:00] Completely true.

Speaker 1 [00:57:01] Completely true. And if I asked you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, what would you say on the same scale?

Speaker 2 [00:57:12] Exactly right.

Speaker 1 [00:57:14] Exactly right. Can I ask you why you answered 9 on our first item, my partner usually really listens to me?

Speaker 2 [00:57:28] How do you know that a person, a person is listening to you, let me put it this way. Well, when we are talking, we are just talking to each other. I mean, there is no TV on, there are no phone calls. Everything the other person says, I mean, I listen to him/her and I can

see at that moment that he/she is listening to me. That moment because it turns into a conversation. So because it's not just one of us talking, because we are talking all the time, I can see that the other person always listens to me and always understands me.

Speaker 1 [00:58:06] Can I ask why you gave the answer 9 and not 8?

Speaker 2 [00:58:13] Because so far there has never been a faltering conversation, a process. I mean, he never chose this from the very beginning. And of course, the fact that we were friends at the time also has an effect on this. I think it also has a positive effect. Before our relationship, we were just people who liked to talk. You know, we knew that we could always listen to each other. I mean, none of us ignored the other when he said something. He never turned a deaf ear. The sentence "I told you so" never came out of our mouths, which happens a lot in family relationships. I say I told you so or the other person says it to each other, but since I never experienced it in our relationship, it was never ignored, so it is not something I said, so it is not 8.

Speaker 1 [00:59:01] May I ask why you answered 9 to our second item, my partner is usually sensitive to my needs?

Speaker 2 [00:59:11] Well, anyway, if I want him to do something, it can be anything. For example, I don't know, a shopping trip home. If I have given such clear information, if he can do it, he definitely does it. It's a request and if the other person does it or tells me to do it, I do it. But apart from that, she can also see my needs without me even realizing it. So, for example, I needed to start a diet, she realized this and guided me in this direction without breaking me, I had a very serious self-confidence problem. But he found a way to guide me without breaking me. Or, for example, I have a field of interest, I am now interested in gramophone, and he took an interest in that field. You know, in many material and immaterial things, he actually guides me, he asks me what he thinks would be good for me. Do you want to do this? You need this. So I think she is sensitive to my needs.

Speaker 1 [01:00:15] Okay. So can I ask you why you answered nine and not eight?

Speaker 2 [01:00:22] Again with the same answer to the other question. I mean, I never felt in that I needed to talk and he never saw that. I have never felt that my partner didn't care about me that day or anything like that. You know, since I can always get the love and devotion I expect from my partner, it is difficult to say 8 there right now.

Speaker 1 [01:00:47] Okay. I hope you don't mind me asking and if this is too sensitive for you to share please feel free to say so. But we also want to know about your physical intimacy as a couple in this project. May I ask how often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2 [01:01:03] He is away now, so we don't have it.

Speaker 1 [01:01:07] Okay.

Speaker 2 [01:01:07] He is in [Location] right now.

Speaker 1 [01:01:09] Hmm. So how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [01:01:14] Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [01:01:16] May I ask why you think so?

Speaker 2 [01:01:18] Of course. It's like, now it's also my first physically intimate relationship. But it is very difficult to realize one's fantasy world. At least I thought it was difficult in this country. But my fantasy world is a bit more tricky, more colorful and I was able to share all of them over time as they came to my mind. And she developed it and we decided to set up a big sex room and we did. We went and got everything from the position chair to the whip to the other tools to the dildos. We said we want this and it happened over time, I mean we didn't go and make a bulk purchase at once, of course. But as our fantasy world develops and I want this, I want to try this, it is an area that we constantly feed and still continue to feed. But this does not mean that we should always take it to the next level, but let's do that too. Okay, we felt like it, let's do it, we didn't feel like it, let's not do it, let's shoot it. And by the way, you can ask all kinds of detailed questions. I can say that I am very comfortable with this.

Speaker 1 [01:02:33] Thank you very much. So how important do you think sexuality is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [01:02:39] I think it's important if the person doesn't identify as asexual. I mean, it is important for us at least. I like physical contact a lot with the things I like. I love to explore. I love to touch, smell, kiss my partner, I love to try a lot of things both on his body and on my body. I also love to realize his fantasies. Or I love to realize my fantasies or to have tried them, not just to realize them, but to have tried them. That's why it's important for us.

Speaker 1 [01:03:16] Okay, now I'm going to share a screen with you again. If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general, which of the following options would you choose?

Speaker 2 [01:03:30] Very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [01:03:32] Very satisfied. And how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship, on a scale of 0: Not satisfied at all, 10: Completely satisfied?

Speaker 2 [01:03:40] I would say 9 here.

Speaker 1 [01:03:43] Okay. Can I ask you why you answered 9?

Speaker 2 [01:03:52] I didn't mean to say completely here. I mean, actually, completely is fine. But it's like, something, how to put it, to use my partner's definition, it's like, feel totally belonging to me - I mean, it scared him that I felt belonging to him, or it scared me that he felt totally belonging to me, that everything is so good. Because at the point where we say everything is very good, everything is perfect, it feels like it will never be lost. But I think it is necessary to know that it can be lost one day. And it is necessary to constantly nourish it. It is always necessary to keep it fresh.

Speaker 1 [01:04:36] Can I ask why you answered 9 and not 8 or 10?

Speaker 2 [01:04:43] So I think there is no such thing as a perfect relationship. Even though we have a very good relationship, there is no relationship where we can say that everything is perfect. It's just like that. It comes to the same place again. You know, to remind ourselves if something happens, the point that yes, anything can happen at any time is actually a click lower.

Speaker 1 [01:05:09] So did this relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2 [01:05:13] It depends on what my expectations were. I had no expectations when I started this relationship. There was nothing that I would have said yes, this relationship is the right relationship. But am I happy? I am happy. If an expectation of mine was met, it was met and I am still in this relationship. But it's not like something like this. That was my goal. It was to live together. I don't know, I can't say that it was met in my relationship because there was no point of expectation such as seeing each other every day, talking every day. But does it make me feel satisfied in general? Yes, it gives me satisfaction.

Speaker 1 [01:05:55] Okay. Well, for example, when we think about the future, what do you think can increase your relationship quality? Is there a point where you say that if these behaviors or these processes increase, my relationship quality will increase?

Speaker 2 [01:06:09] I think our relationship quality will increase if we don't lose our line. Because there is a relationship that feeds each other. So there is a relationship that feeds happiness. And if we don't give up this behavior one day, the quality of our relationship will continue to increase anyway.

Speaker 1 [01:06:25] We are about to finish but I would like to summarize what we talked about in the last hour so that there is no missing parenthesis. You said that you are [26-30] years old and you have been with your partner for [1-5] years. You said that you live with your partner. The story of your relationship started in the community. You were friends for a long time and then it started to turn into a relationship after your partner broke up with his partner at the time. You said that compared to your friends' relationships, you had a funny relationship where respect was never exceeded, there was no disrespect, you had a high quality relationship. Again, you said it was of a higher quality compared to your previous relationships and you said that you don't own each other and you don't feed your emotional hunger. You said that these

are also processes that increase quality. When we asked you what makes a relationship of high quality, you said that it is human happiness. People can be happy with sociability, loneliness, everything. You said that the important thing is to make this understandable with your partner, and here you mentioned that you became close especially during the pandemic and that you were selfless towards each other during that period. When we asked you about the most important elements in a relationship for you, you mentioned respect and the importance of being able to talk, not violating private spaces, and finding common ground. You mentioned that love is something that is felt momentarily, something temporary, and that love is especially important here. You mentioned that love is something that is more permanent, that covers greater happiness, that covers everything positive. But you also said that it would be nice if there was love in a relationship. When we asked how you can tell that your partner shows that he loves you, you said that he tells you, that he does not put you before himself and that he shows this love. Then we talked about queer relationships especially in [Country A]. We talked about the security problems in [Country A], but you also mentioned the advantages here. In particular, you said that it is positive that the things attributed to hetero relationships such as marriage and divorce are not in your relationship. You said that you don't have fights, sometimes you have disagreements, and that these disagreements are things that develop and encourage a higher relationship. In terms of conflict resolution, you mentioned that having an open relationship is very critical for maintaining the relationship. You said that you saw that this relationship was good for you, even perfect, that it was real to be happy without interruption. You said that this relationship changed you, changed everything in your life that made you unhappy, and that meeting your partner together encouraged that. And here again you gave the example of trains traveling on parallel tracks. You said that you feel safe in this relationship. Then you gave answers to our items and here you mentioned that your partner usually always listens to you, that there is usually a conversation, that there is a dialog rather than a mutual monologue. And you mentioned that if you want your partner to do something, if he/she can do it, the other party does not refuse when requested to do it. You mentioned that sexual intercourse is important in a relationship. You said that both you and your partner respect each other's sexual fantasies and that when you want to try it, you try it. You said that you are generally very satisfied in your relationship. You said that it is not a perfect relationship but that your relationship is going on very well. Is there anything else you would like to add or change?

Speaker 2 [01:10:14] Well, at the point of trying these fantasies, you know, when you feel ready, maybe it can be added there. I mean, when we feel ready, you know, every time we say let's try it, yes, let's try it right away. It's something we try when we feel mentally, physically ready, nothing else. That's a very good summary.

Speaker 1 [01:10:39] Thank you very much.

Speaker 2 [01:10:41] Thank you very much. It's great that you are working in such a field.

Speaker 1 [01:10:45] Thank you very much. So now before we finish we would like to talk to you about how we are going to handle the data. As a research project we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. So we want to know which data sharing option is most suitable for you. We

have two options. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain any information that can identify you. This way, our de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a little more daring, is to share your entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, i.e. anonymized. With this option, there is a slim chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down the options for who they believe you are among their colleagues. But I want to reiterate that no sensitive information will be shared and all your information will be shared anonymously. Which of these two options would you prefer?

Speaker 2 [01:11:51] I will probably prefer the second one, but can I ask you something first? For example, I gave details such as [Location], [Location], etc. Will you hide these in the interview? I think you will hide the name and so on anyway.

Speaker 1 [01:12:03] Yes, we will hide these too.

Speaker 2 [01:12:05] Then I would like to choose the second option, because the more information the better.

Speaker 1 [01:12:15] Okay. Finally, thank you again for your participation in this study. I told you that this study has been done in other countries and I would like to remind you again that this is a big project and it has been done in other countries like the Netherlands, the United States, the Philippines. We believe that your views and perspectives will add a lot to this project. In order for this project to be successful, we have one more request for you. Can you nominate 2 close people in your life? We will ask these people to suggest other couples that you don't know and we believe that we can reach more participants, more diverse participants. If it is convenient for you, we will ask you to nominate 2 close people in your life to suggest couples for us. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker 2 [01:13:05] Yes. I don't know if they'll accept it or not. Does it matter if they're queer or straight or not, or any criteria in their relationship? Just the fact that they are a couple?

Speaker 1 [01:13:18] No, not even a couple, they can be alone. We will ask those people to suggest other couples.

Speaker 2 [01:13:24] I see. Well, actually I can suggest four people at this point.

Speaker 1 [01:13:29] Of course.

Speaker 2 [01:13:30] You know, should I ask them first, should I name them first?

Speaker 1 [01:13:34] It would be better if you ask them. If you send me their contact numbers after asking them, if they accept, I will contact them and ask them to suggest us a couple. But as I said, if they approve, it would be more convenient for us if you share it.

Speaker 2 [01:13:50] Okay, so I can think of more than one person, I can ask them all. I can give guidance after asking.

Speaker 1 [01:13:58] Hmm, of course. Thank you very much again. It has been a very enjoyable meeting for us, for me and it has really improved my perspective a lot. I hope it was also enjoyable for you.

Speaker 2 [01:14:09] Very enjoyable for me. I am answering a little serious but thank you

Speaker 1 [01:14:13] It is not important at all. I'm going to share a survey with you in a moment and this survey takes about 10 minutes. I think it's even shorter. I will ask you to fill out this survey when you are free and I will send you a participant code and I will ask you to enter this participant code in the survey where it asks for your name so that your data can remain confidential. Thank you very much again. I wish you a lot of fun with your partner and a lot of happiness in your relationship. Hope to see you soon.

Speaker 2 [01:14:43] See you soon.